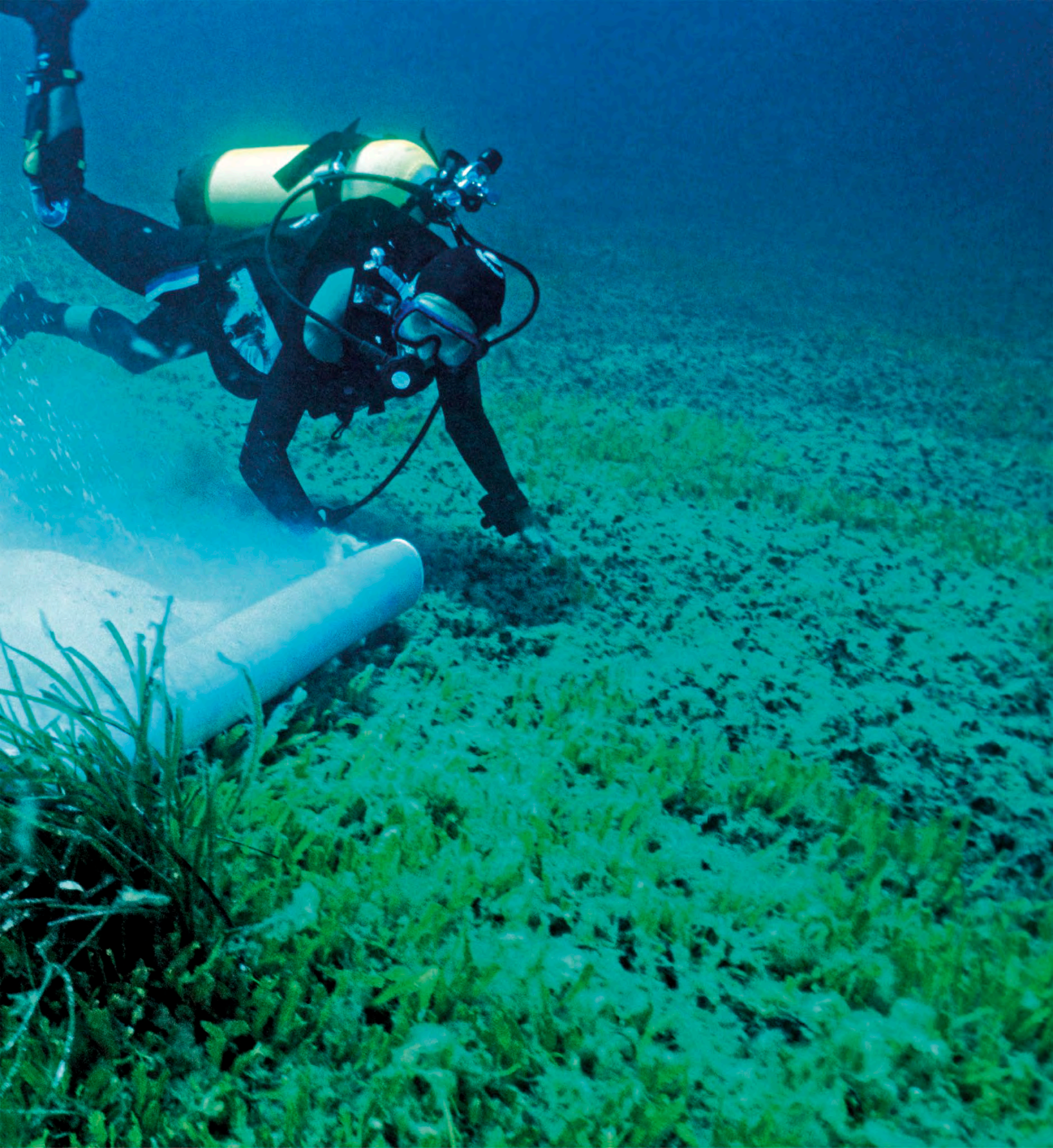




The two divers use chlorine twice in the cleaning process. First, they cover the thick seaweed with a sheet made of PVC, a tough plastic containing chlorine. Next, they pump a compound of sodium and chlorine called sodium hypochlorite under the sheet. This powerful liquid bleach kills the unwanted

seaweed. Several weeks later, the divers return to remove the PVC sheets. The invading seaweed will not regrow, and the plants on the seabed will gradually return. Although chlorine is highly reactive and can damage skin and other body parts, divers are well-protected by their rubber wetsuits.